

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

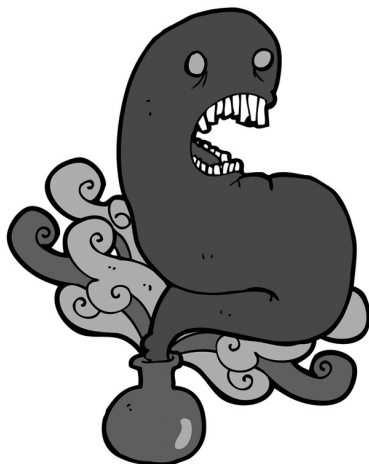
CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Is it really a coincidence?



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What kinds of superstitions have you heard of?
- Do you believe that any superstitions are true? Which ones?
- Has something ever happened to you that you couldn't explain?

Can Do Statements

- I can discuss coincidences and strange events.
- I can say what happened and what was happening.
- I can express opinions, beliefs, events or situations.

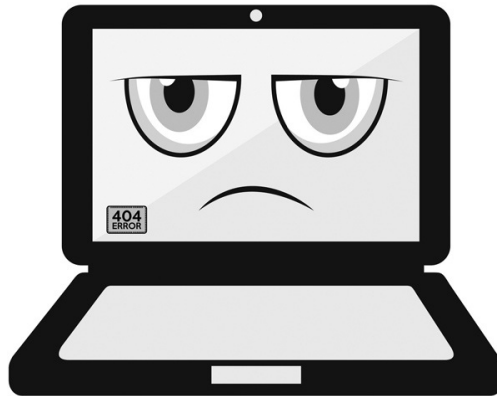




Let's Explore!

Vanessa doesn't **avoid black cats***!

* It is a common superstition that you should "avoid black cats" because they bring bad luck.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** Vanessa, I'm at my wit's end!
- Vanessa:** Peter, what's wrong?
- Peter:** I've lost a really important file. I was working on a file that was saved on my desktop. Suddenly, it disappeared! I swear that there's something really strange going on. First my phone, now my computer. There's a bigger power at work here.
- Vanessa:** Are you sure it's not just a coincidence that they are both having problems at the same time?
- Peter:** I really believe that there's more to it than just a coincidence. Do you believe in superstitions? Do you believe that some of our actions can bring us bad luck?
- Vanessa:** No, not really. Although I do throw salt over my shoulder if I spill it on the table, and I don't open my umbrella inside. But I'm not scared of black cats! I tend to follow the superstitions that are just common sense, like "don't walk under a ladder." Anyway, let's figure out your computer.
- Peter:** Okay. Do you have any ideas of what might have happened? I was saving the document to my hard drive regularly and backing up my files to an external hard drive too. But somehow I deleted this document.
- Vanessa:** Did you save it to a memory stick?
- Peter:** No, I didn't.
- Vanessa:** Did you do a search on your computer for the missing file?
- Peter:** Yes, I did that. I found all the other files that I had saved. I unplugged the modem and plugged it back in.
- Vanessa:** It is really strange that the file disappeared. Maybe we should take your phone and your laptop into the repair shop. I'll come with you.



Let's Practice!

What are these technology words?

Instructions: Read the clues. Find the words in the word search.

Clues

- 1) When two or more things unexpectedly happen at the same time.
- 2) Cause or allow something to flow over the edge of its container, especially unintentionally.
- 3) The ability to use good judgment in making decisions and to live in a reasonable and safe way.
- 4) Happening outside, from an outside source.
- 5) To remove all or part of an electronic or written text.



Let's Practice!

Peter thinks his computer is haunted*.

* Something is “*haunted*” when it has a ghost inside.

Instructions: Write the sentences in the correct category. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- 1) I was working on a file that was saved on my desktop.
- 2) Suddenly, it disappeared!
- 3) I was saving the document to my hard drive regularly.
- 4) But somehow I deleted this document.
- 5) Did you save it to a memory stick?
- 6) I turned off and restarted my computer.

Already happened

Was happening





Extension Activity

Research a superstition.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On the Internet, research superstitions in your country or another country.
- Choose one superstition that is interesting to you and do more research.
- Write a paragraph about the superstition that you chose.
- Read your paragraph to your group.
- Listen to the other students read their paragraphs.
- In your group, decide which superstition is the most believable and which is the least believable.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research a superstition on the Internet.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph about a superstition.

☐ ☐

I read my paragraph to a group.

☐ ☐

I listen to other paragraphs.

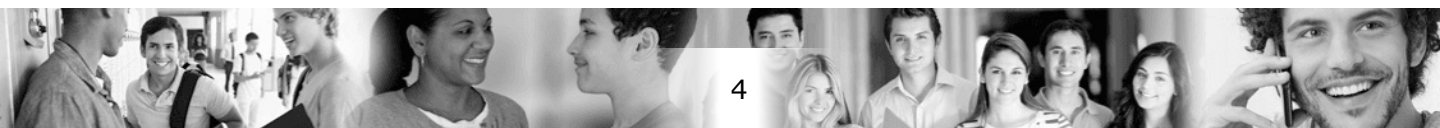
☐ ☐

I choose the most and least believable superstition.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- desktop** (noun): the screen area of a personal computer when no programs are being used
e.g. I was working on a file that was saved on my desktop.
- at my wit's end** (expression): perplexed; at the end of one's ideas
e.g. I'm at my wit's end!
- coincidence** (noun): when two or more things unexpectedly happen at the same time
e.g. Are you sure it's not just a coincidence that they are both having problems at the same time?
- to spill** (verb): to cause or allow something to flow over the edge of its container, especially unintentionally
e.g. Although, I do throw salt over my shoulder if I spill it on the table and I don't open my umbrella inside.
- common sense** (noun): the ability to use good judgment in making decisions and to live in a reasonable and safe way
e.g. I tend to follow the superstitions that are just common sense, like "don't walk under a ladder".
- external** (adjective): happening outside; from an outside source
e.g. I was saving the document to my hard drive regularly and backing up my files to an external hard drive too.
- hard drive** (noun): a disk on which a large amount of information can be stored and used by a computer or other piece of electronic equipment
e.g. I think that my hard drive may be corrupt.
- to delete** (verb): to remove all or part of an electronic or written text
e.g. Somehow I deleted this document.





Learning Points

The Narrative Tenses: Simple Past and Past Continuous

Narrative tenses are verb tenses that are used to talk about the past. They are often found in stories and descriptions of past events, such as personal anecdotes.

The **Simple Past** has several uses in a narrative.

1. To talk about habits in the past: What did the character routinely do? Use adverbs of frequency to add detail here.

For example:

Henry **always made** others laugh.

2. To talk about duration in the past: How long did something happen? Use the prepositions for.

For example:

Henry **lived there for 5 years**.

3. Completed actions: What was the sequence of events and how did they come to an end?

For example:

Henry, badly frightened, **threw** open the trap door in the floor and **climbed** down the ladder into the small, dark hole.

The **Past Continuous** is useful in a narrative. Here are some uses:

1. To talk about an interrupted action: you use the Past Continuous as background to a more important or dramatic event, which is in the past.

For example:

Henry **was preparing** dinner when he sliced his finger.

2. To talk about a simultaneous action. You use the continuous tense to demonstrate that the two actions are happening at the same time, not one after the other.

For example:

I **was saving** the document to my hard drive regularly and **backing up** my files to an external hard drive too. But somehow I deleted this document.

Examples:

- I was working on a file that was saved on my desktop.
- Suddenly, it disappeared!
- Somehow I deleted this document.
- I unplugged the modem and plugged it back in.





Learning Points

Relative Clause or Noun Clause?

After nouns, you use *that* to introduce both relative and noun clauses. Let's look at important differences between the two.

*She made a promise **that she would return all the money**.*

In this example, the noun clause (**that she would return all the money**) adds meaning to the word *promise* and tells us what it is. You cannot replace *that* with *which*.

*She made a promise **that she failed to keep**.*

In this example, we don't know what the promise was (there is no added meaning). You can replace *that* with *which* in relative clauses.

Look at some more examples from the text. Can you identify whether they use noun clauses or relative clauses?

Examples:

- *I found all the other files **that I had saved**.*
- *I tend to follow the superstitions **that are just common sense**, like "don't walk under a ladder".*
- *I swear **that there's something really strange going on**.*
- *Are you sure it's not just a coincidence **that they are both having problems at the same time**?*
- *I really believe **that there's more to it than just a coincidence**.*
- *Do you believe **that some of our actions can bring us bad luck**?*

